

Refund Hunter

A little helper that gets your money back from stores, and only bothers you to ask "yes or no?"

The problem, in one story

Sam buys an air fryer at Target for **\$129.99**. Nine days later, Target drops the price to **\$107.99**.

Here's the thing most people don't know: Target has a rule. If *their own* price drops within 14 days of your order, they will give you the difference back. That's **\$22**, just for asking.

But Sam would have to notice the price dropped, know the rule exists, dig up the order number, write to Target, and then chase them if they don't answer. For \$22? Nobody does that. So the store keeps the money.

This happens all the time. Costco gives you 30 days. Amazon gives your shipping fee back when a package arrives after the date it promised. Grocery delivery apps give a credit when the order is late. Small amounts, everywhere, that almost nobody collects.

What Refund Hunter does

Refund Hunter is a computer program, an **agent**, that does all of that boring work for you. Every morning, on its own:

1 It reads your receipts

It looks at the order emails in your inbox: what you bought, where, how much, when it was supposed to arrive. It ignores newsletters and messages from friends.

2 It knows the rules

It has a little table of store rules: how many days you have to ask for a price adjustment, and what you get when a delivery is late.

3 It checks

For every recent purchase, it looks up today's price and compares delivery dates with the promised ones.

4 It asks you, once

When it finds money, it stops and asks one question. You tap **Yes** or **Skip**. If it finds nothing, you never hear from it.

5 It sends the claim

If you said yes, it writes the email to the store with the order number, the dates, the rule, and the amount, and sends it.

6 It follows up

If the store stays quiet for 5 days, it politely nudges them again. You don't have to remember anything.

REFUND HUNTER

Target dropped the price of your air fryer from \$129.99 to \$107.99. You ordered it 9 days ago, so you're still inside Target's 14-day window. Want me to claim **\$22.00**?

YOU

Yes, file it

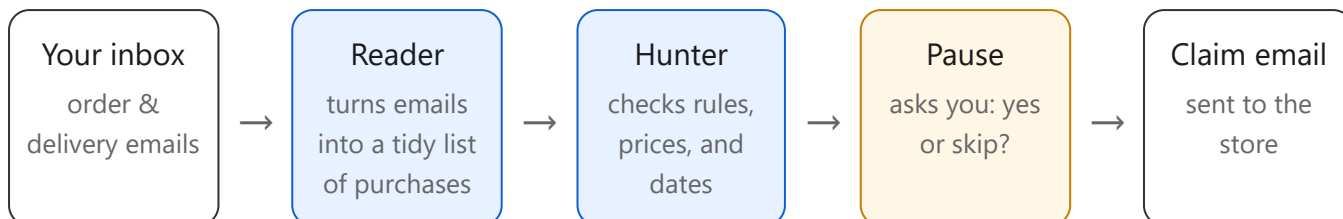
REFUND HUNTER

Done. I emailed Target with your order number and the rule. I'll check back in 5 days if they don't reply.

The simplest way to say it: imagine a very patient friend who reads all your receipts, knows every store's fine print, checks prices every day, and never sends anything without asking you first. That's Refund Hunter.

How it works under the hood

Refund Hunter is made of two small "brains" and a few tools. Each brain is an **AI agent**, built with a toolkit called **Strands Agents** and powered by Claude, an AI model running on Amazon's cloud.



The Reader. Emails are messy. The Reader's only job is to read them and fill in a neat form for each purchase: store, item, price, order date, promised delivery date, and later, the day it actually arrived. It's told to never make anything up: if an email doesn't say a date, the field stays empty.

The Hunter. This is the one that thinks. It has five tools it can use, like buttons on a remote:

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES
list purchases	"Show me everything recent that's still worth checking."
look up policy	"What are Target's rules?" (from the little table of store rules)
check price	"What does this item cost today?" (reads the product page)
close purchase	"This one is too old, stop checking it." (with a reason)
file claim	"There's money here." This tool stops and asks you before doing anything.

The pause is the clever part. When the Hunter presses "file claim," the program freezes right in the middle of the job and saves its exact spot, like bookmarking a page. The question appears on your screen. You might answer in ten seconds or in two days. When you do, the Hunter wakes up at the bookmark and carries on: yes means it writes and sends the email, skip means it drops it. Programmers call this an

interrupt. It's what makes the agent safe: it can never send anything you didn't approve.

The schedule. A timer in the cloud (Amazon EventBridge) wakes the agent once a day. The agent's memory (your purchases, claims, and answers) is kept in a cloud database (DynamoDB). The bookmarks for paused questions are kept in cloud storage (S3). The agent itself runs on Amazon Bedrock AgentCore, which is like a room in the cloud where the agent lives and works.

What you see

One simple page. Four numbers at the top: money found, money claimed, questions waiting for you, purchases being watched. Below that: the questions, the claims, your purchases, and every email the agent sent, so you can read them yourself.

Refund Hunter

Sam Rivera · local agent · dry-run outbox

Run today's check

Reset demo

MONEY FOUND

\$62.99

CLAIMS FILED

\$62.99

NEEDS YOU

0

PURCHASES WATCHED

1

Needs you 0

Nothing needs you. The agent will ask here when it finds money and needs a yes.

Claims

STORE	ITEM	KIND	AMOUNT	STATUS	
Amazon	LEGO Icons Botanical Collection Orchid 10311 Promised delivery date was 2026-09-08; package arrived 2026-09-10, two days late. Shipping fee paid was \$12.99.	late delivery	\$12.99	filed	Got the refund Refused
Target	Ninja Foodi 6-in-1 8-qt 2-Basket Air Fryer (DZ201) Paid \$129.99 on 2026-09-05; current price is \$107.99, a drop of \$22.00. Purchase is 9 days old, within Target's 14-day price-match window.	price drop	\$22.00	skipped	skipped by owner
Costco	Dyson V11 Cordless Stick Vacuum, Extra Tools Paid \$499.99 on 2026-09-02; current price is \$449.99, a drop of \$50.00. Purchase is 12 days old, within Costco's 30-day price-adjustment window.	price drop	\$50.00	filed	Got the refund Refused

Purchases 6

STORE	ITEM	PAID	ORDERED	DELIVERY	STATUS
Walmart	Instant Pot Duo 7-in-1 Electric Pressure Cooker, 6 Qt 2000418-77193	\$89.00	2026-09-08	promised 2026-09-11 arrived 2026-09-11 scheduled window end ?; delivered at 11:20 AM closed: Walmart has no price-adjustment policy; delivery arrived on the promised date (2026-09-11) and shipping fee was \$0.	closed
Amazon	LEGO Icons Botanical Collection Orchid 10311 113-4471820-2291001	\$49.99 +\$12.99 shipping	2026-09-06	promised 2026-09-08 arrived 2026-09-10 scheduled window end ?; delivered at 3:12 PM	claimed
Target	Ninja Foodi 6-in-1 8-qt 2-Basket Air Fryer (DZ201) 102-5583920	\$129.99	2026-09-05	promised 2026-09-09	open
Costco	Dyson V11 Cordless Stick Vacuum, Extra Tools 5211093774	\$499.99	2026-09-02		claimed
Home Depot	DEWALT 20V MAX Cordless Drill/Driver Kit WG73015566	\$99.00	2026-08-29	closed: Within Home Depot's 30-day window but current price is unchanged at \$99.00 — no refund due.	closed
Best Buy	Sony WH-1000XM5 Wireless Noise Canceling Headphones - Black BBY01-806623014	\$348.00	2026-08-25	closed: Outside Best Buy's 15-day price-adjustment window (ordered 2026-08-25, now day 20).	closed

Emails the agent sent 2

Late delivery refund request, order 113-4471820-2291001 → delivery.guarantee@amazon.example

outbox (dry run)

Things worth knowing

- **It never spends or sends without a yes.** The only thing it does on its own is read and check.
- **The demo uses a pretend inbox.** Made-up person, made-up orders. The same program can read a real Gmail inbox if you give it permission.

- **The store rules live in a plain text file** anyone can edit. If a store changes its policy, you change one line.
- **If it can't find today's price** for something, it claims nothing. Better silent than wrong.

Refund Hunter was built for the AWS "Agents for Humans" hackathon, Everyday Agents track, with the Strands Agents SDK and Amazon Bedrock AgentCore. Open source, MIT license:
github.com/fakemovement/refund-hunter